

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: April 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

- March 2026

Locked

March 2026 is locked (closed 2 Apr 2026). These numbers won't change.
- April 2026

Locked

April 2026 is locked (closed 5 May 2026). These numbers won't change.
- October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

April's jobs made \$68,843 gross margin (41.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$6,456 and overheads \$59,290, leaving \$3,097 profit before tax (1.9% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.8% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$68,843
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$48,144
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$6,456
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$62,387
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$59,290
Profit before tax (the P&L)	\$3,097
Revenue	\$164,987
Gross margin on jobs, %	41.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	1.9%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	39.8%

Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, April · All jobs

41.7%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · All jobs

35.6%

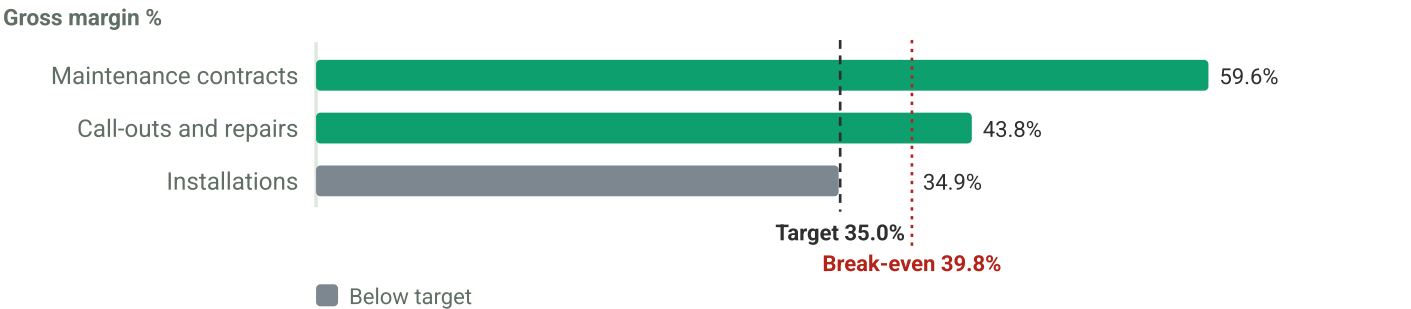
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

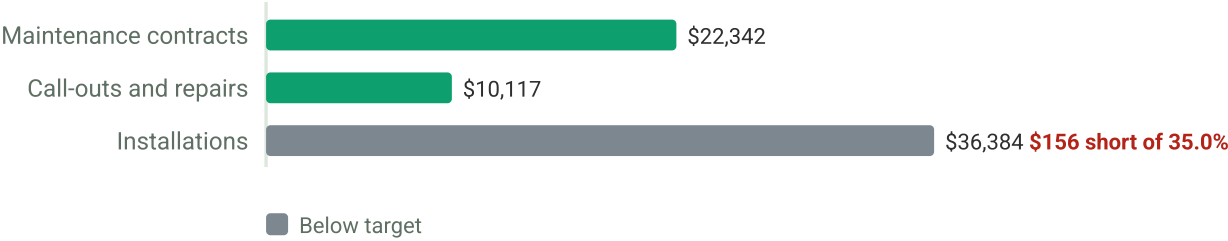
39.8%

covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Job gross margin by type of job, April 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In April maintenance contracts made a 59.6% job gross margin, installations made a 34.9% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 43.8% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 39.8% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 34.9% gross margin, 0.1 points under the 35.0% target: about \$156 on \$104,400 of revenue in April. It's below the 39.8% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 59.6% gross margin, 24.6 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,217 ahead on \$37,500 in April).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

Job gross margin, April · Maintenance contracts

59.6%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · Maintenance contracts

59.6%

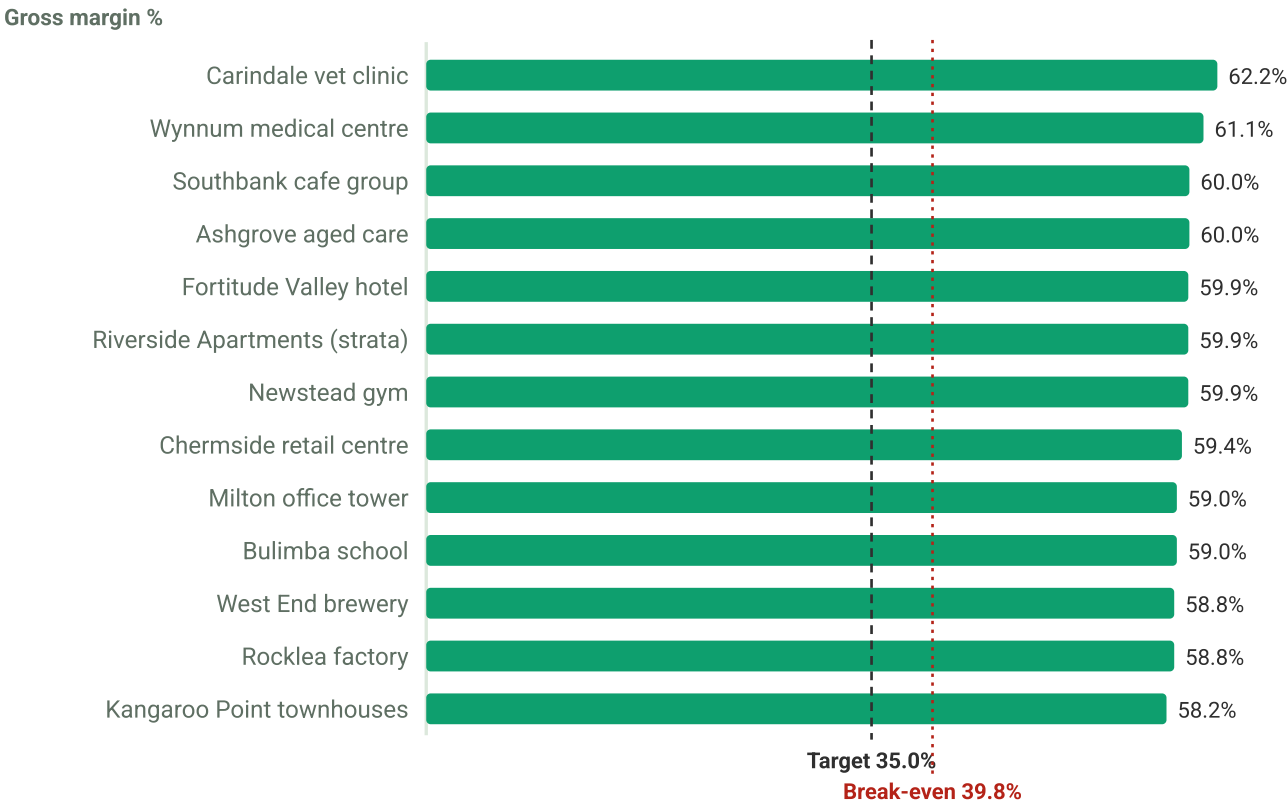
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

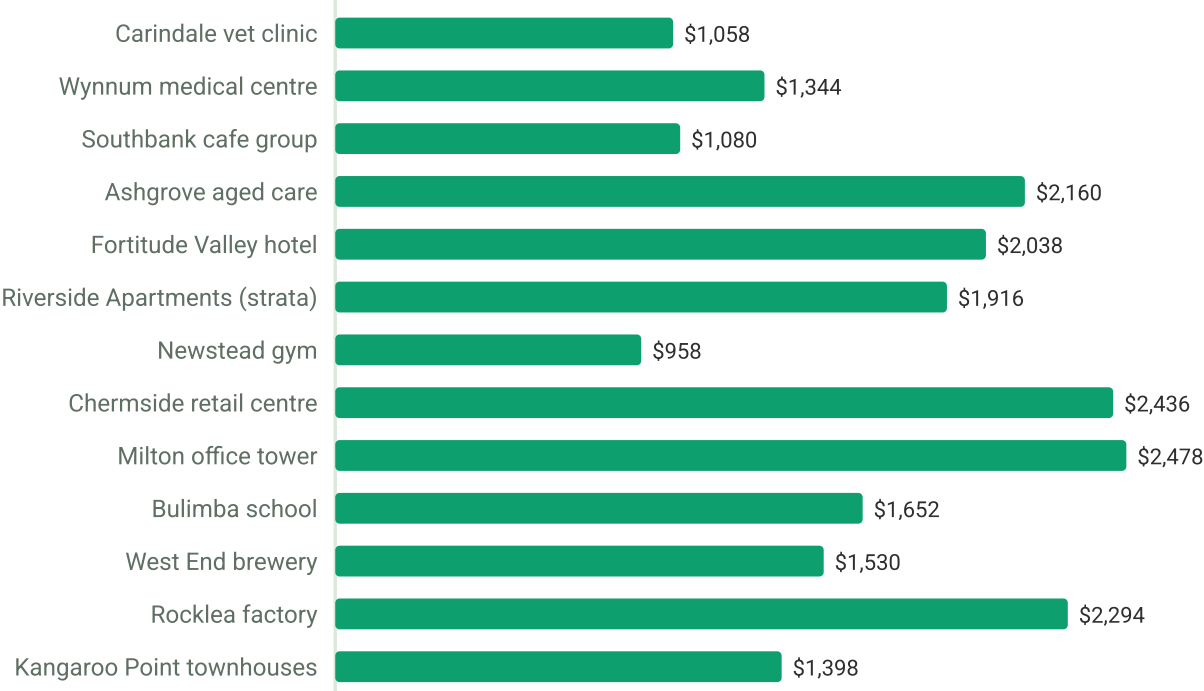
39.8%

covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, April 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

All 13 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 58.2% gross margin, 23.3 points over the 35.0% target (\$558 ahead on \$2,400 in April). All maintenance contracts: 59.6% gross margin, 24.6 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,217 ahead on \$37,500 in April).

Type of job: Installations

Job gross margin, April · Installations

34.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · Installations

27.1%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

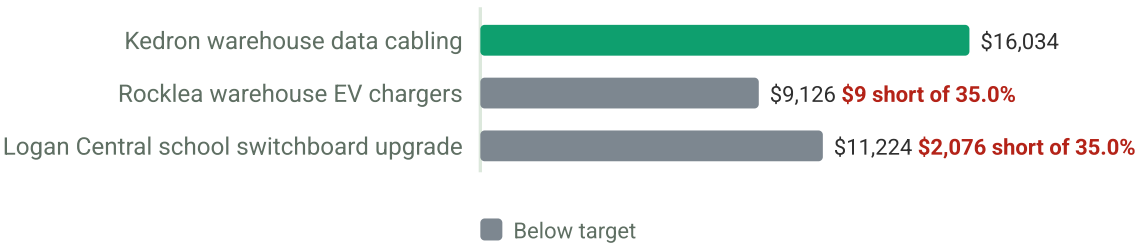
39.8%
covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in April 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

2 of the 3 installation jobs invoiced in April made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Logan Central school switchboard upgrade made a 29.5% job gross margin: 132.0 h of technician time (\$8,976) and \$3,800 of subcontractors on a \$38,000 job. Jobs need 39.8% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

2 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about \$2,085 between them on \$64,100 of revenue. The biggest gap, Logan Central school switchboard upgrade: 29.5% gross margin, 5.5 points under the 35.0% target: about \$2,076 on \$38,000 of revenue in April. It's below the 39.8% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, April · Call-outs and repairs
43.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · Call-outs and repairs
43.5%
target 35.0%

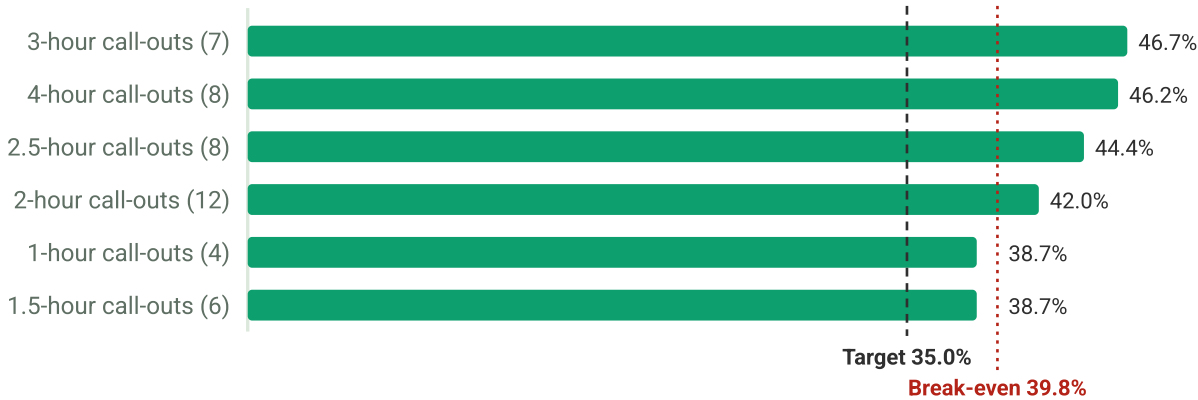
Gross margin jobs need to break even
39.8%
covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Technician time charged, April
\$15,950
69.1% of call-out revenue

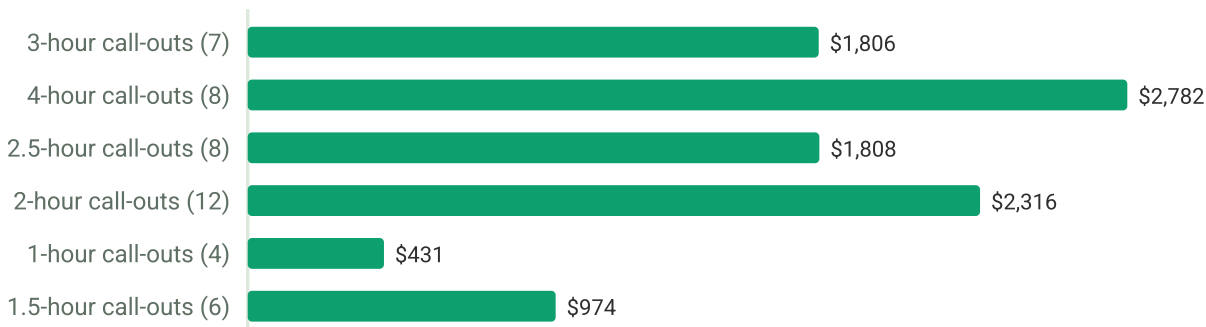
Materials charged, April
\$7,137
\$5,490 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, April 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

45 call-outs in April billed \$15,950 of technician time and \$7,137 of materials (\$5,490 at cost plus 30%), and made a 43.8% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 38.7% to 46.7% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

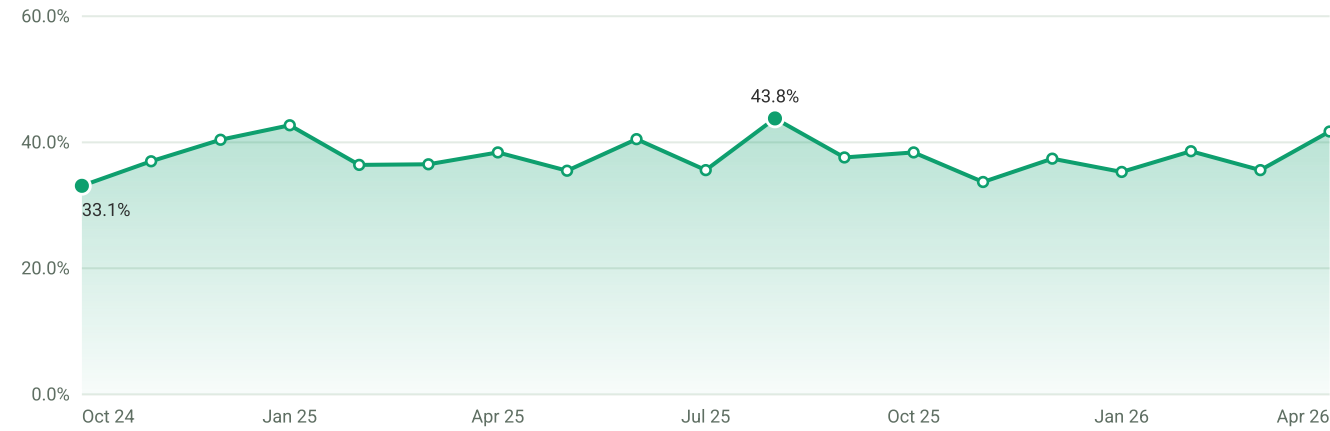
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 43.8% gross margin, 8.8 points over the 35.0% target (\$2,037 ahead on \$23,087 in April).

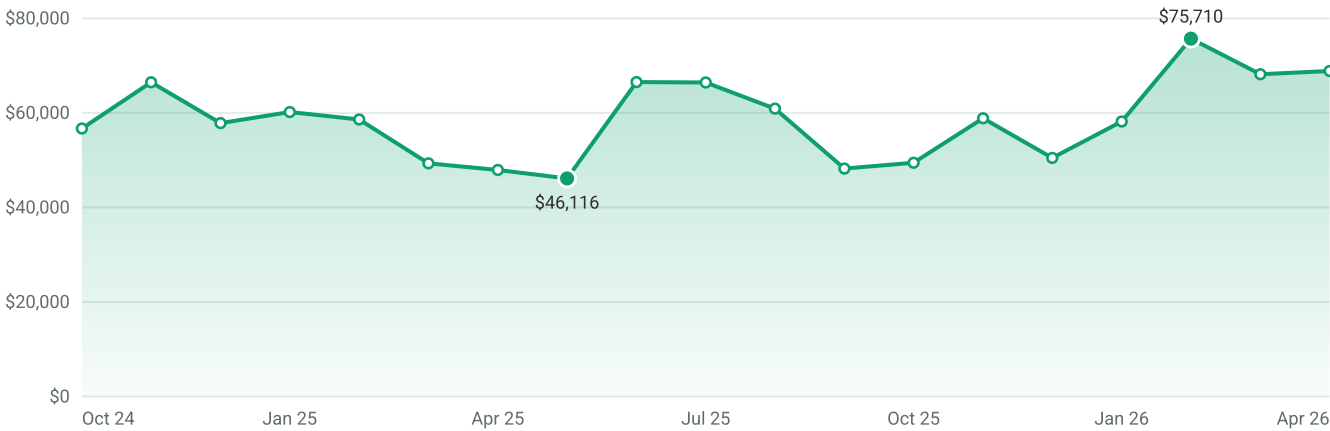
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the Excel download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.